NEWS 👍

Rwanda Genocide Memorials Added to the National Heritage List :

The sites at Nyamata, Murambi, Gisozi and Bisesero in Rwanda commemorating the mass killings of mainly Tutsi victims were "just inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage list", the organization posted on social media on Wednesday

The Nyamata Memorial Site

The Gisozi Memorial Site

The Murambi Genocide Memorial Site :

The Bisesero Genocide Memorial Site :

Benefits of being registered in the National Heritage List :

Recognition and Prestige: Inclusion on the World Heritage List is a mark of international recognition and prestige. It signifies that the site is of outstanding value to humanity and deserves protection and preservation.

Tourism and Economic Benefits: UNESCO-listed sites often see an increase in tourism, which can boost the local economy. Tourists are attracted to these sites because of their cultural or natural significance, which ca
n result in increased revenue from tourism-related activities.

Preservation and Conservation: UNESCO listing can lead to increased efforts and resources for the preservation and conservation of the site. Governments and organizations often prioritize the protection of these sites to maintain their World Heritage status.

Education and Research: UNESCO-listed sites can become hubs for education and research. They provide opportunities for studying cultural heritage, biodiversity, geology, and other fields of science and history.

Cultural Exchange: World Heritage Sites often become focal points for cultural exchange and cooperation between countries and regions. This can foster international understanding and collaboration.

Infrastructure and Development: Governments may invest in infrastructure development in and around World Heritage Sites to accommodate tourists, which can benefit local communities by improving roads, utilities, and services.

Sustainable Development: The UNESCO designation encourages sustainable development practices. Authorities and communities are often motivated to balance tourism and economic development with environmental and cultural preservation.

Protection from Threats: UNESCO recognition can help draw attention to threats facing a site, such as development, pollution, or natural disasters. This can lead to international support for efforts to mitigate these threats.

Community Engagement: Local communities are often involved in the management and preservation of World Heritage Sites. Their engagement can lead to a sense of pride and ownership over the site's heritage.

Promotion of Culture: UNESCO-listed cultural sites contribute to the preservation and promotion of cultural heritage, helping to ensure that traditions, customs, and historical knowledge are passed down to future generations.

ABARINZI B'IGIHANGO The Pride of Rwandans

The Rwandan Genocide was a horrific and brutal ethnic conflict that occurred in 1994 in the African country of Rwanda. For approximately 100 days, an estimated 1,000,000 people, primarily from the Tutsi ethnic group, were systematically killed by Hutu extremists. The genocide was a result of longstanding ethnic tensions and political power struggles in the region.

Today we are going to talk about the Hutu who instead of practicing in the massacres like the others chose to help the people who were being massacred, The Tutsi.

Known by the name ABARINZI B'IGIHANGO these are the people who had a kind and loving heart and helped people who were being massacred in Rwanda during the Genocide Period.

There are many of these people, those who are recognized by the government and those who are yet to be recognized by the government. But one of the most popular of these people is :

GISIMBA MUTEZIMBERE Damascene

Damas Mutezintare Gisimba, a protector of friendship pact(umurinzi w'igihango) and a philanthropist who saved many during the Genocide against Tutsi has died aged 62 at Nyarugenge hospital-Kigali.

Gisimba, is the founder of Centre Memorial Gisimba in Nyarugenge District. The center saved hundreds of orphans who did not have any support around them before, during, and after the Genocide against Tutsi.

And, during the 1994 Genocide against Tutsi particularly, many Tutsis found refuge at his center, and he declined any access to Interahamwe militia who wanted to exterminate them, pledging to lose his life rather than abandon them.

By doing this, Gisimba was taking a big risk; death. But he believed the fear of death was less important than witnessing innocent people, especially children, get killed.

"I could not watch with my own eyes as people got killed. I decided to do all I could," Gisimba told KT Press a couple of years ago.

As the 100-day genocide went on, information circulated that he was hiding people and Gisimba started getting death threats from the killers, but this did not deter him an inch. He rescued more than 300 children into his orphanage.

When attackers threatened to burn down his orphanage, he looked for other means. "I contacted an American friend who helped me relocate them to St. Michel cathedral church. That's how we survived," Gisimba told KT Press.

In November 2015, Gisimba was recognized by President Paul Kagame with a medal of guardian of friendship pact- umurinzi w'igihango during a 'Unity Award 2015' gala organized by Unity Club, the organization of spouses of Rwandan leaders which is chaired by First Lady Jeannette Kagame.

Below is a Summary of All (ABARINZI BIGIHANGO)

Gatoyire Damien: During the Genocide, in the Gasange Sector, Gatsibo District, Gatoyire prevented killings in the area through an anti-genocide campaign.

Silas Ntamfurayishyari: He served in Habyarimana's Ex-FAR army and was stationed in Gako, Bugesera district. He was placed at roadblocks to stop Tutsi and hand them to killers, but he would later secretly let them go. During the genocide, he accompanied 17 people to cross into Burundi.

Aaron Habumugisha:. He mobilized residents in his village not to kill and managed to stop attacks from outside and nobody was killed there.

Father Obald Rugirangonga: He initiated a program that brings together victims and perpetrators in Rusizi District. Through this program, 153 families have been reunited. He also tours different prisons to encourage inmates to repent and ask for forgiveness.

Boniface Mudenge: A Genocide survivor, he founded Inyenyeri- an association that promotes unity and reconciliation in Rubavu District.

Aloys Uwemeyimana: During the Genocide, he helped 119 people flee to DRC and paid ransom for them to survive.

Father Servilien Nzakamwita: All his relatives were killed during the Genocide. He has spent most of his time doing charity work. Recently he built houses for Rwandans who were repatriated from Uganda and Tanzania in the Gicumbi District. He is the first Catholic monsignor who initiated visits of prisoners.

Frederic Mpankiriho: Mpankiriho passed away. He tried to give ransom to killers to save people who had fled to his home in Nyanza District. He was killed when he refused to forsake them.

Callixte Kabera: Kabera was an ex-FAR soldier. He was always victimized for sympathizing with the Tutsi.

Father Eros Borille: He is an Italian Catholic priest. He used his Saint Antoine orphanage in Nyanza during to save people.

It is estimated that 800 people survived because of him. As the situation worsened, his fellow priests told him to fly back home, but refused. He fell ill but refused to be hospitalized and continued with his people.

Father Stanislas Urbanik: He is a Catholic priest from Poland. He started his evangelization in 1992 during the multiparty period. He continuously preached about love and harmony. His teachings bore fruits when the people he had taught helped him save 600 people who had come to seek refuge at Ruhango parish. He was detained and then released. During the Genocide, he was given a gun to kill but rather used it to protect victims. He was killed for that.

Father Jerome Masinzo: Has been the leader of the Butare Diocese since 1988. During the Genocide, he led Ngoma Parish and helped in reconciliation activities and rehabilitation for 1,800 widows of the genocide.

Father Dion Marius: Is credited for saving 15 people who had fled to him in Kacyiru, Gasabo district. He resisted several attacks of Interahamwe. UNAMIR soldiers forced him and other foreigners to leave, but he and another Swiss man refused to abandon the people he was hiding. He currently works at King Faisal Hospital.

Ramadhan Munyakazi: During the Genocide, Munyakazi helped Tutsi to cross the Nyabarongo River, but was unfortunately killed when he returned after his young brother betrayed him.

Josephine Murebwayire: Currently living in Gasabo district, she gathered women and girls and sensitized them through workshops. She also provided counseling and reconciliation talks. She currently works as a mediator between perpetrators and victims of the genocide anthem and a champion of Ndi Umunyarwanda program.

Damas Gisimba Mutezintare: He is the founder and owner of Gisimba Memorial Centre. During the Genocide, he rescued and hid over 300 children and adults from Interahamwe militias. After the genocide, Gisimba sheltered orphans and paid their school fees.

Grace Uwamahoro: At the age of 13 during the Genocide, Uwamahoro saved a baby from breastfeeding on her dead mother. The mother pleaded with the passersby to take the baby, but nobody took the baby. Uwamahoro took the baby and fled to the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC). She resisted the pressure from her relatives to leave the child behind. She raised the baby and named her Vanessa Uwase. The girl is now finalizing senior six at Maranyundo Girls School in Bugesera district.